PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | CrowdStrike | Entra ID | Threat Detection and Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and identity security within complex enterprise environments. I have extensive hands-on experience operating CrowdStrike Falcon across the full platform (Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover, OverWatch), alongside Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), and Mimecast email security. My career has centred on threat detection and response, alert triage, and EDR/Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert handling at scale, protecting an estate of over 8,000 users. I am comfortable working in small, focused security teams, contributing across SIEM/SOAR operations, vulnerability remediation, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), email and web security gateways, and security awareness training.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, automation playbooks, workbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, SOAR automation via Logic Apps and PowerShell
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, OverWatch) - Expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast (email security, URL rewriting, impersonation protection); Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, web application firewall (WAF), DDoS protection concepts
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Security Awareness:** Phishing simulation programmes, end-user training campaigns
- **Mobile Device Management:** Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Conditional Access
- **Threat Detection:** Detection engineering, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, alert tuning, threat hunting
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, root cause analysis, post-incident reviews, P1-P4 management
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL; SOAR workflow development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operate and maintain the SIEM/SOAR platform (Microsoft Sentinel) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, overseeing threat detection, alert triage, and incident response across the 8,000-user estate.
- Lead EDR/XDR alert handling through CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, triaging alerts, investigating threats, and coordinating containment and remediation.
- Administer and tune email and web security gateways, including Mimecast, to detect and block phishing, malware, and business email compromise attempts.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and analyst overhead on high-frequency alert types by approximately 40%.
- Manage identity security through Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies, and investigating identity-based threats including account compromise and privilege escalation.

- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege principles and protect high-risk accounts from credential-based attacks.
- Conduct vulnerability remediation cycles using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), prioritising findings by risk and tracking to closure with asset owners.
- Deliver penetration test remediation follow-up, ensuring findings are tracked, prioritised, and remediated within agreed timescales.
- Contribute to security awareness training initiatives including phishing simulation exercises and targeted training for high-risk user groups.
- Manage Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management and Mobile Application Management) policies for endpoint compliance and Conditional Access enforcement.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operated the SIEM platform (Microsoft Sentinel), developing KQL detection rules, analytics, and automated alerts to identify threats aligned to MITRE ATT&CK across endpoint, identity, and cloud environments.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon for endpoint protection and threat hunting, triaging EDR/XDR alerts and conducting investigations that spanned malware, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios.
- Led the enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 endpoints, designing onboarding processes, baselines, and alert response playbooks.
- Administered Mimecast email security, managing policy configurations, investigating email-borne threats, and producing detailed incident reports.
- Managed vulnerability management using Tenable.io and AppCheck, conducting scans, analysing results, and working with system owners on prioritised remediation.
- Enforced identity security through Microsoft Entra ID and BeyondTrust PAM, managing Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout, and privileged access governance.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 compliance activities, providing audit evidence and delivering remediation plans for identified gaps.
- Contributed to security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce the risk of human-targeted attack vectors.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained security controls across cloud and on-premise infrastructure, including endpoint protection, identity management, and email security gateway configuration.
- Managed Azure Active Directory, including MFA deployment, access policy reviews, and SSO integrations.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and security assessments, producing reports for senior leadership and overseeing remediation activities.
- Administered Microsoft Intune for endpoint compliance and Mobile Device Management across the organisation's device estate.
- Supported incident response and contributed to business continuity and disaster recovery planning in a fast-paced SaaS environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 users at UAL, achieving full EDR coverage and establishing a structured alert triage and response capability.
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced analyst manual steps by approximately 40% for common alert types, improving operational efficiency within a small security team.
- Built a proactive threat detection programme combining CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying multiple pre-alert incidents through targeted threat hunting.
- Led vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, validating detection coverage and driving down the organisation's exploitable risk surface through systematic remediation.
- Designed and enforced Conditional Access and MFA policies in Microsoft Entra ID, significantly reducing the risk of identity-based compromise across the estate.

- Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus recertification and contributed to ISO 27001 audit preparation, demonstrating adherence to recognised security frameworks.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)